Weisheng Zhang

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Research Fields
Microeconometrics, particularly network and panel data.

Education

University College London — London, UK
Ph.D. in Economics — May 2027 (expected)
Advisors: Aureo de Paula and Andrei Zeleneev
MRes in Economics — 2022

University of Notre Dame — IN, US
Master in Economics — 2021

Peking University — Beijing, China
Master in Economics — 2020
B.S. in Geophysics — 2017

Job Market Paper
"*Causal Inference under Dynamic Selection and Latent Heterogeneity*" 2026

Abstract: I study dynamic treatment effects in panel data under staggered adoption when treatment timing depends jointly on unobserved time-invariant heterogeneity and time-varying pretreatment covariates, including lagged outcomes. Untreated potential outcomes follow a nonparametric dynamic panel model that allows flexible interactions between time-varying covariates and latent heterogeneity. I use pretreatment outcome histories to find individuals with similar time-invariant latent factors, and the key requirement is that these histories are sufficiently informative about those latent factors. I develop an identification strategy for the dynamic average treatment effect on the treated (ATT) and propose kernel-based doubly robust estimators for the dynamic ATT. I further combine double cross-fitting with undersmoothing and show that, under suitable regularity conditions, the proposed estimators are root-n consistent, asymptotically normal, and asymptotically unbiased. The simulation study demonstrates that the proposed method provides accurate inference across a wide range of data-generating processes. I illustrate the method with an application to the U.S. family planning program studied by Bailey (2012) and reestimate its effects on fertility rates.

Working Papers

1. "*Tractable Estimation of Nonlinear Panels with Interactive Fixed Effects*" with Andrei Zeleneev [Submitted] 2025
2. "*Flexible Imputation of Incomplete Network Data*" with Ge Sun [Submitted] 2026

Work in Progress

1. "*Panel Models with Interactive Fixed Effects and Low-Rank Regressors*"
2. "*An Econometric Analysis of Non-Bayesian Social Learning*"
   with Shuyang Sheng, Guanyi Wang, and Yuanqi Zhang

Teaching Experience

ECON0019, Econometrics (UCL, Undergraduate)	2025 - Present
ECON0010, Math for Economists (UCL, Undergraduate)	2024 – 2025
ECON0115, Household Economics (UCL, Undergraduate)	2022 - 2024
Chinese Economy (Peking University, Undergraduate)	2018

Seminar and Conference Presentations

2026: Econometric Society East & Southeast Asia Meeting (Hanoi), Econometric Society Africa Meeting (Cairo), UCL-CeMMAP Ph.D. Econometrics Research Day, UCL Econometrics Brownbag Seminar.
2024-25: UCL-CeMMAP Ph.D. Econometrics Research Day, UCL Econometrics Brownbag Seminar.

Scholarship

Centre for Microdata Methods and Practice (CeMMAP) PhD scholar, 2022-present

Skills and Languages

Languages: English (fluent), Mandarin Chinese (native)
Programming: R, C++

References

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